BLACKBOARD MARKING RUBRIC

Design Phase Rubric

How Your Submission Will Be Assessed

Design Docs · 30

Diagrams · 25

Prototypes · 25

Traceability · 20

Rubric Structure at a Glance

Four scored sections (100 marks) plus one holistic quality section.

Section	Title	Criteria	Marks
A	Design Documents	A1 High-Level Design (15) · A2 Detailed Design (15)	30 marks
B	Diagrams & Visual Aids	B1 Architecture/Topology (8) · B2 Sequence/Flow (9) · B3 Data/ERD (8)	25 marks
C	Prototypes & Mockups	C1 Description (8) · C2 Screenshots (9) · C3 Functionality (8)	25 marks
D	Requirements Traceability	D1 Completeness (10) · D2 Justification Quality (10)	20 marks
E	Design Evaluation & Academic Quality	E1 Feasibility/Scalability/Security · E2 Writing & Referencing — holistic, informs overall mark	Holistic

How to Read the Performance Bands

Every criterion is marked against four descriptive bands — not a single pass/fail line.

Excellent (90–100%)	Proficient (75–89%)	Developing (50–74%)	Not Yet Competent (0–49%)
The criterion is fully and expertly satisfied. Depth, precision, and professional presentation throughout.	The criterion is well satisfied with minor gaps. Solid, competent work with small room for refinement.	The criterion is partially satisfied. Noticeable gaps in depth, clarity, or completeness.	The criterion is not satisfied. Missing, superficial, or fundamentally incorrect content.

Each of the 9 scored criteria (A1–D2) is assessed against these four bands, then translated into a numeric mark within its point range.

SECTION A

Design Documents

30 marks

A1 High-Level Design Document (15 pts)

15 pts

Excellent (90–100%)	Proficient (75–89%)	Developing (50–74%)	Not Yet Competent (0–49%)
Comprehensive, logically sound HLD. All major components identified. Interactions fully described. Appropriate depth for project complexity.	Well-structured HLD covering most components. Minor gaps in interaction descriptions or justification.	HLD present but lacks depth. Architecture partially described. Components or interactions unclear or missing.	HLD absent, incomplete, or does not reflect the project. No coherent architecture presented.

A2 Detailed Design Document (15 pts)

15 pts

Excellent (90–100%)	Proficient (75–89%)	Developing (50–74%)	Not Yet Competent (0–49%)
Thorough technical detail for all modules, algorithms, and interfaces. Pseudocode/structured notation used appropriately. Fully aligned with HLD.	Most modules and interfaces addressed with adequate technical depth. Minor gaps that do not undermine quality.	DDD present but technically shallow. Modules partially described. Algorithms or interfaces vague or missing.	DDD absent or insufficient. Negligible technical detail that does not support implementation.

💡 *Reference: Template Sections 3.1 (HLD) and 3.2 (DDD)*

SECTION B

Diagrams and Visual Aids

25 marks

B1 Architecture / Topology / System Diagram (8 pts)

8 pts

Excellent (90–100%)	Proficient (75–89%)	Developing (50–74%)	Not Yet Competent (0–49%)
Accurate, clearly labelled, professionally presented and captioned. Fully represents structure. Referenced in body text.	Present and adequately labelled. Minor labelling or referencing issues. Captures main structure.	Included but lacks labels, caption, or referencing. Partially represents the system.	Absent or does not meaningfully represent the system.

B2 Sequence / Interaction / Flow Diagram (9 pts)

9 pts

Excellent (90–100%)	Proficient (75–89%)	Developing (50–74%)	Not Yet Competent (0–49%)
Correct notation. Covers at least one primary use case/process in full. All actors, messages, flows labelled. Explanation provided.	Correct and covers main flow. Minor notation errors or missing labels. Adequate explanation.	Notation errors, missing actors, or incomplete flows. Limited explanation.	Absent or fundamentally incorrect.

B3 Data / ERD / DFD / Wireframe (8 pts)

8 pts

Excellent (90–100%)	Proficient (75–89%)	Developing (50–74%)	Not Yet Competent (0–49%)
Normalised (ERD min. 3NF), fully labelled entities/attributes/keys/relationships or flows. Directly supports design.	Adequate. Most entities/flows labelled. Minor normalisation or labelling issues.	Partially complete. Key entities, relationships, or flows missing or unlabelled.	Absent or does not reflect the project data model or flows.

💡 *Minimum 3 distinct diagram types required — see Template Section 4*

SECTION C

Prototypes and Mockups

25 marks

C1 Prototype / Simulation Description & Scope (8 pts)

8 pts

Excellent (90–100%)	Proficient (75–89%)	Developing (50–74%)	Not Yet Competent (0–49%)
Clearly described, scope defined, tools identified. Directly linked to project objectives and design decisions.	Adequate description. Scope mostly defined. Tools identified. Minor gaps linking to design decisions.	Vague description. Scope unclear. Tool use partially described. Weak connection to design.	No meaningful description. No tool use evidenced.

C2 Screenshots / Simulation Outputs (9 pts)

9 pts

Excellent (90–100%)	Proficient (75–89%)	Developing (50–74%)	Not Yet Competent (0–49%)
Three or more annotated screenshots/outputs, each captioned and referenced. Annotations highlight specific design elements.	Two or more screenshots/outputs. Most captioned. Annotation partially complete.	One or two screenshots. Limited captioning or annotation. Insufficient quality for assessment.	No screenshots or outputs provided, or images unrelated to the project.

C3 Functionality Explanation & Design Validation (8 pts)

8 pts

Excellent (90–100%)	Proficient (75–89%)	Developing (50–74%)	Not Yet Competent (0–49%)
Clearly links prototype behaviour to design requirements. Demonstrates how prototype validates specific design decisions.	Adequate explanation. Most features linked to requirements. Minor gaps in validation discussion.	Present but superficial. Limited linkage to requirements or design decisions.	No meaningful explanation. Prototype not linked to design or requirements.

💡 *Reference: Template Section 5 — annotate every screenshot with what it validates*

SECTION D

Requirements Traceability

20 marks

D1 Completeness of Traceability Matrix (10 pts)

10 pts

Excellent (90–100%)	Proficient (75–89%)	Developing (50–74%)	Not Yet Competent (0–49%)
All requirements from Analysis Phase represented. Each row has requirement ID, design element, and justification. No gaps.	Most requirements traced. One or two rows incomplete or missing justification.	Partially complete. Multiple requirements untraced or justifications absent.	Absent, or fewer than half of requirements traced with justification.

D2 Quality and Specificity of Justification (10 pts)

10 pts

Excellent (90–100%)	Proficient (75–89%)	Developing (50–74%)	Not Yet Competent (0–49%)
Specific, technical justifications clearly explaining how each design element addresses its requirement. Design elements referenced by section/figure.	Adequate and mostly specific justifications. Some generic or lack design cross-references.	Vague or repetitive justifications. Limited specificity. Design elements not clearly identified.	Absent or do not meaningfully link requirements to design.

Example row:

REQ-004 (SMS reminders) → Twilio SMS Integration Module (§3.2.1) → "Reduces no-shows by 40% per BMC Health Services Research (2022)"

SECTION E

Design Evaluation & Academic Quality

Holistic

These criteria do not carry independent marks — they inform mark adjustment across all sections.

E1 Feasibility, Scalability & Security Discussion

Excellent (90–100%)	Proficient (75–89%)	Developing (50–74%)	Not Yet Competent (0–49%)
All three dimensions addressed with technical depth. Risk matrix complete with realistic mitigations.	At least two dimensions addressed adequately. Risk matrix partially complete.	Present but lacks depth. One or two dimensions superficially addressed.	Absent or does not address the project context.

E2 Academic Writing, Referencing & Presentation

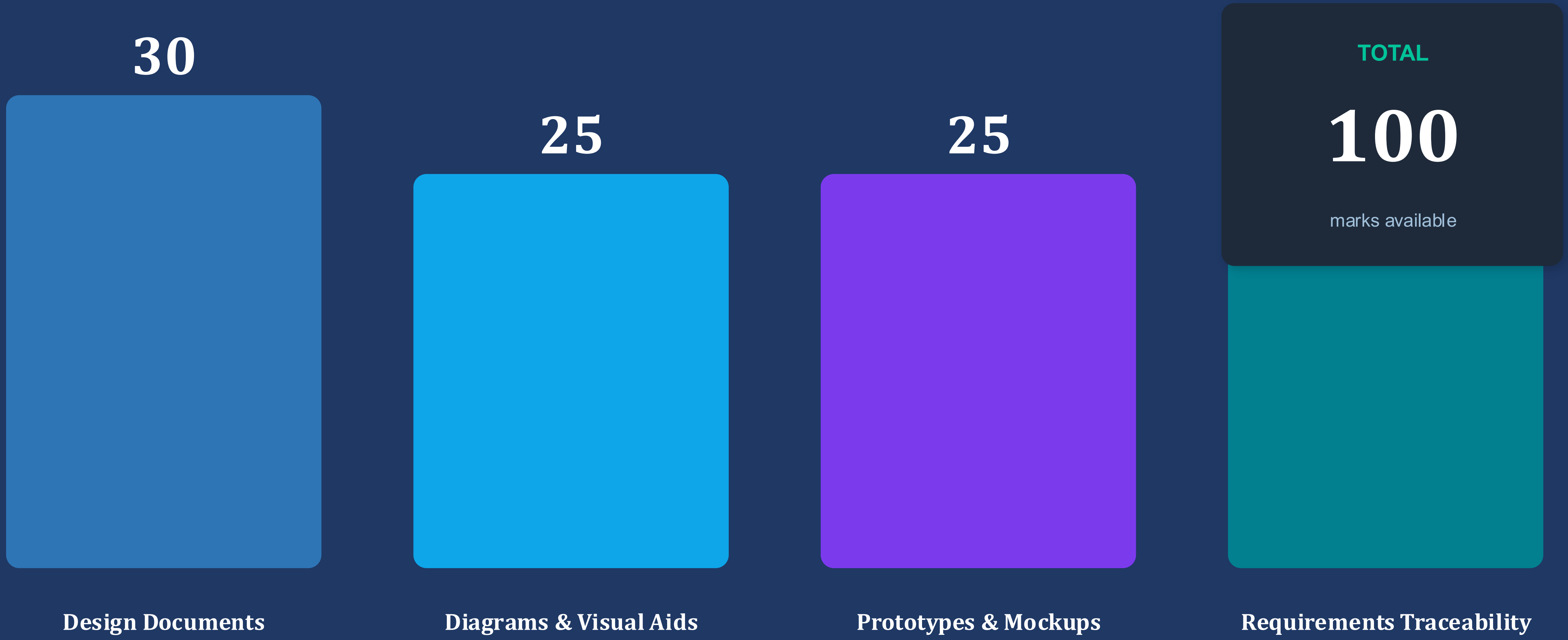
Excellent (90–100%)	Proficient (75–89%)	Developing (50–74%)	Not Yet Competent (0–49%)
Formal tone throughout. Min. 5 correctly formatted references. No spelling/grammar errors. Professional structure.	Generally formal. 3–4 references correctly formatted. Minor language or formatting issues.	Informal language present. Fewer than 3 references. Noticeable errors.	Poor academic writing. Minimal or no referencing. Significant presentation deficiencies.

Grade Band Descriptors

Your total score (out of 100) determines your overall grade band.

Grade Band	Score	Descriptor
Distinction	90 – 100	All criteria met at an exemplary level. Diagrams, documents, and prototypes are professionally executed and fully labelled. Traceability is complete. Writing is fluent and referencing impeccable.
Merit	75 – 89	Most criteria met to a high standard. Minor gaps in one or two areas. Clear technical competence. Traceability mostly complete. Writing clear, referencing adequate.
Pass	50 – 74	Core criteria met satisfactorily. Some gaps in technical depth, diagram quality, or traceability. Functional design demonstrating adequate domain understanding.
Not Yet Competent	0 – 49	Significant criteria not met. Major deficiencies in design documents, diagrams, or traceability. Insufficient design readiness. Resubmission required.

Where Your 100 Marks Come From



Note: Section E (Design Evaluation & Academic Quality) carries no independent marks but adjusts scores across all four sections above.

Before You Submit: Self-Check

Run through this checklist — it mirrors exactly what the assessor checks against the rubric.

- ✓ All required diagrams clearly labelled with figure numbers and captions
- ✓ At least three distinct diagram types included (not variations of one type)
- ✓ Prototype screenshots are annotated and each image is captioned
- ✓ Traceability matrix links every requirement to a specific design element
- ✓ Stream-specific section (§8) fully completed — other streams marked N/A
- ✓ Security and risk evaluation addressed (feasibility, scalability, security)
- ✓ All references formatted consistently (Harvard or APA 7th)
- ✓ Appendices complete and referenced in the body text
- ✓ Document proofread — formal academic language throughout

Know the rubric. Meet the standard.

Every mark on this rubric is earned through evidence, clarity, and deliberate design.

📊 **This rubric is loaded in Blackboard against the Design Phase Assignment**

Questions about your mark? Speak to your supervisor first, then the module coordinator.